

TrueVal-Chains Consortium Partner Skillset Evaluation

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Purpose: Assess whether each named partner has the demonstrated skillset to accomplish their assigned role.

Rating Scale

RATING	MEANING
Excellent fit	Partner has deep, directly relevant track record
Good fit	Partner has relevant expertise with minor gaps
Partial fit	Some relevant experience; gaps are meaningful
Weak fit	Institutional name is credible but individual or specific expertise is not verified
Gap / Unknown	Insufficient public evidence to assess

1. TrueValue Analytics: Dr Sarah Jones and Jeff Milton (Alicante / Buenos Aires)

Assigned role: cTVF methodology, project and communications coordination, digital platform, biodiversity and ecosystems specialists.

What research found:

The cTVF is not the product of a single framework. It is a collaborative synthesis of two distinct but complementary intellectual traditions:

1. **The Tholonic Framework** (Jeff Milton): The structural and mathematical foundation. Jeff Milton established the N-D-C triadic model, including its recursive self-similar structure and convergence on fundamental mathematical constants. The tholonic framework provides the analytical architecture: how phases are structured, how D and C interact, and how sustainability is measured as balance.
2. **The True Value Framework** (Sarah Jones, Clarity Coalition): The applied economic and supply chain methodology. Sarah Jones has been a practitioner of True Value accounting since at least 2010, with focus on internalizing environmental and social costs into economic value. The Clarity Coalition's True Value Futures project provides the field-level implementation: data collection protocols, blockchain timestamping of supply chain data, cooperative engagement, and Scope 3 accounting.

The cTVF integrates both: the tholonic N-D-C structure governs phase architecture and sustainability measurement, while the True Value methodology provides the economic, environmental, and social accounting layer. This synthesis is the methodological core of the proposal and has been validated on the global gold supply chain (Phases 0 through 7).

The "biodiversity and ecosystems specialists" sub-role within TrueValue Analytics is not attributed to a named individual with a verifiable ecology or biodiversity credentials profile. The proposal treats this capacity as existing within the team without naming or evidencing it.

Assessment: Good fit

- cTVF methodology: Excellent fit. The cTVF is a collaborative synthesis: Jeff Milton contributes the tholonic structural framework and Sarah Jones contributes the True Value applied methodology. Together, and only together, they hold the full intellectual foundation of the cTVF. No other pairing in the field could replicate this combination.
- Project and communications coordination: Good fit based on existing Clarity Coalition project delivery.
- Digital platform: Plausible but not specifically evidenced beyond existing cTVF tools.
- Biodiversity/ecosystems specialization: Not evidenced for either named individual. This remains a gap that could weaken the proposal's response to call requirements on natural capital and IPBES alignment.

Recommendation: The proposal should make the dual-framework origin of the cTVF explicit: the Tholonic Framework (Milton) provides the architectural model, and the True Value Framework (Jones, Clarity Coalition) provides the applied accounting methodology. Making this clear converts an apparent weakness into a distinctive methodological strength no competing consortium can match. The biodiversity/ecosystems specialist remains the outstanding gap and should be named.

2. Shea Coordinator: ImpactAgri, Jon White (Marseille) OR Serious Shea SARL, William Kwende

Assigned role: Coordination of shea supply chain data and analytics for West Africa.

Note on the "OR" construction: The proposal presents these as alternatives rather than both confirmed. This is a structural weakness: a Horizon RIA consortium must be fully constituted at submission. The final partner should be named and committed.

ImpactAgri, Jon White

Jon White is co-founder and former CEO of ImpactAgri (Marseille), with 40 years of agribusiness experience including executive roles at Netafim. ImpactAgri led the "Serious Shea" project in Burkina Faso, targeting 10,000 MT/year of shea butter through 10 eco-processing centers, with funding from the African Development Bank and World Bank. The project is explicitly structured around women's cooperative equity and sustainable sourcing.

Assessment: Good fit for shea supply chain operations and logistics. Jon White's direct leadership of a large-scale shea supply chain project in Burkina Faso is directly relevant. However, ImpactAgri's specific capacity for quantitative supply chain data collection and analytics (the cTVF phase-resolution requirement) versus project implementation is less clear from public information.

Serious Shea SARL, William Kwende

Serious Shea SARL is led by William Kwende and operates across the Sahel (Burkina Faso, Senegal, Mali, Nigeria). The organization implements a deforestation-free, zero-carbon shea value chain with blockchain-timestamped True Value data collection through the Clarity Coalition's True Value Futures technology. Serious Shea won the 2021 UN-endorsed Great Green Wall Challenge and has direct cooperative networks with thousands

of women shea producers. Critically, it already uses the True Value data collection framework.

Assessment: Excellent fit for this specific proposal. Serious Shea's existing use of the Clarity/cTVF True Value data framework, direct GGW corridor operations, and cooperative ownership structure align precisely with the project's shea workpackage goals. Kwende is an established practitioner with field-level relationships and operational infrastructure.

Overall recommendation for this role: Serious Shea/Kwende is the stronger choice given the direct alignment with the cTVF data collection methodology already in place. The "OR" must be resolved before submission.

3. Cooperativas Agro-alimentarias de España (Madrid)

Assigned role: Coordinate data and input with Spanish Cooperatives (olive oil, Spanish cherries workpackage).

What research found:

Cooperativas Agro-alimentarias de España is the national federation representing Spanish agri-food cooperatives. As of mid-2025, the organization operates the Cooperative Field Notebook (C3) digital data system across 100+ cooperatives involving 1,100+ farmers in 12 autonomous communities. This was developed under the AGRICOOP BIGDATA Horizon project (2019-2021). They have active data digitalization and analytics capability and deep relationships across Spain's cooperative sector.

Assessment: Good fit

- Data coordination with Spanish cooperatives: Excellent fit. As the national federation, they have unique access that no research institution could replicate.
- Supply chain data collection and formatting for cTVF: Good fit. Their C3 system and SIGCEX GIS tools demonstrate genuine data infrastructure.
- Analytical research outputs: This is not their primary function. They are a coordination and advocacy body. Expecting them to produce independent quantitative analysis would overstretch their role. The proposal correctly positions them as data input coordinators, not analysts.

Recommendation: Role is correctly scoped. Confirm that C3 data formats can be exported in ways compatible with cTVF schema requirements. Clarify which specific cooperative sub-federations (olive, cherry, shea not applicable here) will be engaged.

4. University of Malaga, AGORA

Assigned role: Agrifood supply chain and value chain data model verification; Andalusian data input coordination.

What research found:

AGORA Datalab is a formal innovation and research center at the University of Malaga specializing in Data Spaces. It is the lead organization building the Agri-Food Data Space of Andalusia (EDAAn), funded by Spain's State Secretariat for Digitalization and AI (SEDIA). AGORA's demonstrators include crop yield prediction (satellite/sensor), pest monitoring, water stress monitoring, and AI-based food distribution optimization. It operates in the European data space ecosystem (GAIA-X, IDSA frameworks) and conducts data interoperability certification, proof-of-concept validation, and pilot incubation.

Assessment: Good fit with one important qualification

- Agrifood data infrastructure and interoperability: Excellent fit. AGORA is doing exactly this at scale.
- Andalusian data coordination: Excellent fit. Their regional relationships with cooperatives, farms, and administrations are well-established.
- cTVF "data model verification": Good fit for verifying data standards and interoperability, but their expertise is in data space architecture, not specifically the tholonic N-D-C supply chain phase model. There is no evidence that AGORA has prior familiarity with the cTVF analytical framework. They will need to develop familiarity with the cTVF schema conventions before they can verify the model.

Recommendation: The AGORA role should be explicitly framed in two stages: (1) an onboarding phase where they learn the cTVF schema and phase structure, then (2) independent model verification using their data space expertise. This is realistic and credible. The ROBIN Horizon Europe project (also Andalusia) mentioned in the proposal as a complementary partner should be explicitly linked to AGORA's coordination role.

5. CIPPEC, Buenos Aires: Lic Diego Moreno

Assigned role: Argentine deforestation-free soya, beef, nexus; data input coordination.

What research found:

Diego Moreno holds a degree in Biological Sciences from the University of Buenos Aires and has over 20 years in environment and sustainable development. He served as Argentina's Secretary of Environmental Policy, Climate Change and Sustainable Development (2015-2019) and directed Fundación Vida Silvestre Argentina (2008-2015). At CIPPEC, he leads research on the Gran Chaco deforestation nexus, co-authored a study with the IDB on Argentina's 2007 forest protection law, and produced a sustainable agro-industrial production policy proposal directly addressing soy/beef-driven deforestation (60% of native forest loss, 39% of national GHGs).

Assessment: Excellent fit

Moreno's profile is unusually well-matched to the assigned task. He combines:

- Scientific training (biology, ecology)
- Senior government experience (Secretary of Environmental Policy)
- Civil society leadership (Vida Silvestre)
- Current applied research at CIPPEC directly on soy/beef/deforestation nexus in the Gran Chaco

CIPPEC is one of Latin America's most credible policy think tanks with strong EU institutional relationships. The EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR) has direct operational implications for Argentine soy and beef, and CIPPEC/Moreno's existing work on traceability systems for agricultural supply chains aligns closely with the project's data requirements.

Recommendation: This is one of the strongest individual appointments in the consortium. Consider whether Moreno can also serve as a bridge to Argentine government contacts for data access from SENASA (national animal health/traceability) and MAGYP (agriculture ministry).

6. CEPS, Brussels: Dr Cinzia Alcidi

Assigned role: Policy, global supply chains, EU imports, Mercosur Trade Agreement.

What research found:

Dr Cinzia Alcidi is a Senior Research Fellow and Head of the Economic Policy unit at CEPS, with a PhD in International Economics from the Graduate Institute (Geneva). Her primary expertise is macroeconomics, EU economic governance, and social policy. CEPS as an institution has published directly on the EU-Mercosur Free Trade Agreement, including agricultural implications, and the EU-Mercosur iTA provisionally entered into force on 1 May 2026. CEPS also has research on trade competitiveness and agri-food trade between the EU and Mercosur countries.

Assessment: Partial to Good fit

- EU policy analysis: Excellent fit. CEPS is one of Europe's foremost independent policy research institutions.
- Mercosur Trade Agreement: Good institutional fit. CEPS has published directly on EU-Mercosur agricultural trade.
- Global supply chain economics: Plausible institutional fit, though Alcidi's personal specialization is macroeconomics and EU governance rather than supply chain analytics specifically.
- Natural capital or deforestation regulation compliance: Not evidenced as Alcidi's area. The EUDR policy interface would need to be covered by either Alcidi or a named CEPS colleague with specific EUDR expertise.

Recommendation: Clarify which named CEPS colleague or team will lead on EUDR-specific policy work, as this is distinct from Mercosur trade policy. If Alcidi is the primary point of contact, her macroeconomic EU governance expertise is a genuine asset for the broader policy recommendation workpackage. Consider whether CEPS can contribute a second named expert with specific trade-and-environment credentials for the EUDR dimension.

7. CREA, Roma

Assigned role: Specialists in Italian supply chain and value chain imports for olive oil.

What research found:

CREA (Consiglio per la Ricerca in Agricoltura e l'Analisi dell'Economia Agraria) is Italy's national agricultural research council, directly supervised by the Ministry of Agriculture, Food Sovereignty and Forests. CREA's Research Centre for Olive, Fruit and Citrus Crops (OFA) covers the full olive oil supply chain: genetic improvement, production sustainability, quality enhancement, by-product valorization, crop protection, and organic farming. The Oleario project integrates CREA's production, agricultural policy/bioeconomy, and food/nutrition centers in a coordinated olive oil research programme.

No specific individual from CREA is named in the proposal.

Assessment: Excellent institutional fit

CREA OFA is precisely the right institution for this role. Italy is the world's second-largest olive oil producer and the destination for the dominant Spain-to-Italy bulk trade flow that the proposal explicitly identifies as a value appropriation case study. CREA has:

- Full supply chain research from agronomy through to by-product economics
- Policy research capacity (agricultural policy and bioeconomy center)
- Nutritional and food quality expertise
- Existing integration across these areas via the Oleario project

Recommendation: Name a specific lead researcher from CREA for the proposal. An anonymous "CREA, Roma" designation weakens the evaluation panel's ability to assess individual expertise. A researcher from CREA's Agricultural Policy and Bioeconomy Center with olive oil value chain publications would be ideal. Consider pairing with an OFA researcher for the physical supply chain phases.

8. CIFOR-ICRAF (Benin)

Assigned role: Agrifood, socio-economics research (supporting the shea/West Africa workpackage).

What research found:

CIFOR-ICRAF (Center for International Forestry Research and World Agroforestry) has extensive published research on shea in Benin specifically, including:

- Shea yield assessment under different land-use regimes in Atacora district
- Ecological adaptation of shea along climatic gradients in Benin
- Morphotype classification and farmer preference studies
- Women's shea value chain economics ("Globalizations in a nutshell: Opportunities and risks for women shea producers in West Africa")

CIFOR-ICRAF operates the world's leading agroforestry research program and has deep institutional presence across the Sahel corridor relevant to the Great Green Wall linkage.

No specific individual from CIFOR-ICRAF is named in the proposal.

Assessment: Excellent institutional fit

CIFOR-ICRAF's body of work on shea in West Africa is among the most comprehensive in the academic literature. Their combination of agroforestry ecology, socioeconomics, and gender-focused value chain research maps directly onto the project's requirements for shea phase resolution and women cooperative data. Their Benin location gives them direct field access.

Recommendation: Name a lead researcher. CIFOR-ICRAF Benin has identifiable researchers publishing on shea systems; naming one would strengthen the proposal significantly. Also clarify whether CIFOR-ICRAF will cover the GGW corridor broadly or focus on Benin-specific data.

Cross-Cutting Observations

Strengths of the consortium as assembled

1. The Argentina / EUDR workpackage is exceptionally strong. CIPPEC/Moreno is the most individually verified appointment in the consortium with directly relevant published research, government experience, and policy credibility.
2. The shea West Africa component (Serious Shea/Kwende, CIFOR-ICRAF) has genuine operational and research depth.
3. CREA and AGORA are well-chosen institutions with directly relevant mandates.
4. CEPS provides essential Brussels policy credibility and has institutional publication history on EU-Mercosur.

Gaps requiring attention before submission

GAP	SEVERITY	ACTION REQUIRED
Jeff Milton: role and framework origin not explained in proposal	Low	Clarify that Milton established the Tholonic N-D-C model that underpins the cTVF architecture
"Biodiversity/ecosystems specialists" unnamed	High	Name individual(s) with ecology/IPBES credentials
ImpactAgri OR Serious Shea: unresolved "or"	High	Confirm single partner; recommend Serious Shea
CREA: no named individual	Medium	Name lead researcher with publication record
CIFOR-ICRAF: no named individual	Medium	Name lead researcher
Alcidi: EUDR-specific expertise not evidenced	Medium	Add named CEPS colleague or clarify scope
AGORA: unfamiliar with cTVF schema	Low-medium	Plan onboarding phase in WP1

Framework alignment risk

The cTVF is a collaborative synthesis of the Tholonic Framework (Jeff Milton) and the True Value Framework (Sarah Jones/Clarity Coalition). The tholonic N-D-C architecture provides the structural model; the True Value methodology provides the applied accounting layer. This dual origin is a strength, not a complication, but it means the cTVF is held entirely within TrueValue Analytics. All other partners will need structured onboarding to work within it. The proposal should include a dedicated training and schema-standardization task in WP1 to manage this risk and demonstrate to evaluators that the methodology can be transferred across a diverse consortium.

Individual vs institutional balance

Several of the consortium's strongest entries are institutional (CREA, CIFOR-ICRAF, Cooperativas, AGORA) without named individuals. Horizon RIA evaluators typically expect named key personnel with verifiable CVs. Strengthening the named-individual layer across the non-TrueValue partners would materially improve the proposal's score on the "quality and efficiency of the implementation" criterion.

Evaluation prepared based on: document 260504 Horizon Europe Abstract v3.docx; web research conducted May 2026 on CEPS, CIPPEC, CREA, CIFOR-ICRAF, ImpactAgri, Serious Shea, Cooperativas Agro-alimentarias de España, University of Malaga AGORA.